

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage for Hindus: Hindu teachings about the importance and purpose of marriage in Hindu life, including Rig Veda 10.85.36–47; divergent Hindu, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and Hindu responses to them.
2.2	Hindu teachings about the nature and importance of sexual relationships; Hindu teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 5.21–23; divergent Hindu teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Hindu responses to them.
2.3	Hindu teachings about the purpose and importance of the family – procreation, security and education of children, with reference to Bhagavad Gita 1.37–43; divergent Hindu responses to different types of family within 21st century (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the local Hindu community: how and why the community tries to support families (with reference to Bhagavad Gita 1.37–43), including through worship, rites of passage, festivals and counselling; the importance of the support of the local Hindu community for Hindu families today.
2.5	Hindu teaching about family planning and regulation of births: divergent Hindu attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to the householder stage, with reference to Bhagavad Gita 3.37–43; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them.
2.6	Hindu teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage: Hindu teachings about divorce and remarriage, including reference to the Hindu Marriage Act 1955 (India) and arguments used to support or reject divorce; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them.
2.7	Hindu teachings about the equality of men and women in the family: Hindu teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family, including reference to Manusmriti 3.55–60; divergent Hindu attitudes about the equality of men and women in the family.
2.8	Hindu teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Hindu opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.29–32; examples of gender equality in action in Hinduism.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The nature and purpose of Hindu yoga: the nature and purpose of different forms of yoga, karma yoga (action), jnana yoga (knowledge), astanga/raja yoga (meditation) and bhakti yoga (devotion); examples of when each form of yoga might be used, how and why; the importance of having different types of yoga; reference to Bhagavad Gita 6.44–47.
3.2	Focuses of worship and representations of the divine: the nature, purpose and importance of different ways of worshipping, including worshipping one god (personal or non-personal) or many deities, gurus and holy places (land, hills, rivers and sacred plants and animals); the scriptural basis for the different focuses of worship and representations of the divine in worship, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.20–31.
3.3	The importance of Hindu places of worship: the nature, features of, use, and purpose of worship in different places, including in the temple, in the home, outside, shrines and festival celebration and in the space of the heart, with reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 9.13–27; the benefits for Hindus of having different places to worship in.
3.4*	The nature and purpose of prayer in the temple and the home: the nature, features of use and purpose of the different forms of worship, including meditation, puja, havan, darshan, arti, bhajan, kirtan and japa, with reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.44–47; divergent understandings of the benefits for Hindus of having different forms of worship.
3.5	Hindu sacred festivals: the nature, history, purpose and significance of Hindu sacred festivals; the origins and meaning of specific festivals, including Diwali, Holi, Navratri Dussehra, Ram Navami, Ratha-yatra, Janmashtami, and Raksha Bandhan, including interpretations of Brhadaranyaka Upanishad 1.3.28.
3.6	Hindu pilgrimage: the nature, history and purpose of Hindu pilgrimages; the significance of the places Hindus go on pilgrimage; divergent understandings of why pilgrimage may, or may not be, important for Hindus today; the nature, features, history and importance of pilgrimage to the Ganges, including interpretations of Rig Veda 10.75, Vrindavana and Varanasi.
3.7	Hindu environmental projects: divergent understandings of the nature, purpose and significance of environmental care for Hindus; the importance of care for rivers and sacred places for Hindus; how Hindus care for the environment, examples of what they do and why, including reference to cow protection and interpretations of Rig Veda 10.87.16–19.
3.8	Hindu charity work: the nature and purpose of charity for Hindus; Hindu teachings about charity; the work of one named Hindu charity working to promote wellbeing, social inclusion and women's rights, what it does and why, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 3.10–12.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Hindu teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Hindu responses to them, including Rig Veda 10.129; the compatibility of Hindu beliefs and science; the value of the universe in Hinduism; divergent Hindu responses to the possible view that the universe may be used as a commodity.
4.2	Hindu teachings about the sanctity of life: why human life might be regarded as holy; how life is shown as special in the scriptures, including interpretations of Katha Upanishad 1.3.3; the importance of sanctity of life for Hindus today.
4.3	Hindu responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins and value of human life, such as evolution and survival of the fittest; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Hindus today, including interpretations of Rig Veda 10.129.
4.4	Implications of the Hindu teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; divergent Hindu teachings about abortion, including interpretations of Atharva Veda 6.113; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them.
4.5	Hindu teachings about life after death: Hindu teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death, including Bhagavad Gita 4.23–30; divergent Hindu responses to arguments for life after death (remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones who have passed on); the significance of belief in life after death for Hindus.
4.6	Hindu responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Hindus reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Bhagavad Gita 15.6–12.
4.7	Implications of the Hindu teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: the nature of euthanasia; Hindu teachings about euthanasia, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 7.25–30; divergent Hindu, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use; the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them, including support for hospice care.
4.8	Hindu responses to issues in the natural world: Hindu responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources; Hindu teachings about environmental care, including The Hindu Declaration on Nature – Assisi 1986 and interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 13.27–34; divergent Hindu responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.